

Daniel 1

A Tale of Two Cities: Jerusalem and Babylon; AND the Four (ch. 1)

Text Structure:

A	vss. 1-2						
	vss. 3-4						
	vs. 5						
	vs. 6						
	vs. 7						
	vss. 8-10						
	1	ii	vss. 11-20	vss. 11-16	vs. 11		
					vss. 12-16	vs. 12a	
						vss. 12b-13a	
						vss. 13b-15a	
vss. 15b-16							
2	i'	vs. 17					
		vss. 18-20	vss. 18-19				
			vs. 20				
1'	ii'	vs. 21					

Text:

¹ In the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, came Nebuchadnezzar king of **Babylon** unto **Jerusalem** and besieged it. ² And the Lord gave into his hand, Jehoiakim king of Judah and part of the vessels of the house of God and he carried *these* into the land of Shinar to the house of his god and he brought the vessels into the treasure house of his god.

³ And the king said unto Ashpenaz, the master of his eunuchs, that he should bring certain of the children of Israel and of the seed of the king and some of the princes; ⁴ young men in whom was not in *them* any blemish and *having a fair appearance* and **skillful** in all **wisdom** and cunning in knowledge and **understanding science** and such as *had* ability in *them* to stand in the palace of the king and whom they might teach **the language** and the literature of the Chaldeans.

⁵ And the king appointed for them each day a daily provision of **the king's delicacies and of the wine which he drank** and so nourishing them three years, that at the end thereof they might stand before the king.

⁶ And among *these* of the children of Judah were **Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah**.

⁷ And the chief of the eunuchs gave unto them names and he gave unto **Daniel** the name of Belteshazzar, and unto **Hananiah** of Shadrach, and unto **Mishael** of Meshach, and unto **Azariah** of Abed-nego.

⁸ But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with **the portion of the king's delicacies nor with the wine which he drank** therefore he requested of the chief of the eunuchs that he might not defile himself. ⁹ And God had brought Daniel into favour and tender love with the chief of the eunuchs. ¹⁰ And the chief of the eunuchs said unto Daniel, I fear my lord the king who has appointed your food and drink for why should he see your faces worse liking than the young men which *are* of your sort? Then shall you make me endanger me head to the king.

¹¹ Then said Daniel unto the steward, whom the chief of the eunuchs had set over **Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah**.

¹² **Prove**, I beg you, **your servants ten days**.

and let them **give us** some **vegetables** even to eat and water even to drink. ¹³ And **let our appearance and the appearance of the young men who eat of the portion of the king's delicacies** be looked upon before you

and as you see, deal with **your servants**. ¹⁴ And he consented to them in this matter and **proved them ten days**. ¹⁵ And at the end of **the ten days**

their appearance looked fairer and fatter in flesh than all the young men who did eat the portion of the king's delicacies.¹⁶ And thus the steward took away their portion of delicacies and the wine that they should drink and gave them vegetables.

¹⁷ And as for these four young men, God gave them knowledge and skill in all language and wisdom and Daniel had understanding in all visions and dreams.

¹⁸ Now at the end of the days when the king had said to bring them in, then the chief of the eunuchs brought them in before Nebuchadnezzar. ¹⁹ And the king interviewed them and none was found among them all like Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah, therefore they stood before the king.

²⁰ And in all matters of wisdom *and* understanding about which the king examined them, yea, he found them ten hand-spans above* all the magicians *and* astrologers who *were* in all his realms.

*taller *and* more heavenward towards the gods

²¹ And Daniel continued until the first year of Cyrus the king.

vss. 1-2,21— “Babylon ... Jerusalem” vs. Cyrus: Cyrus not only brought about the fall of Babylon, thus, freeing the captive Jews, but he also published a decree allowing their return to Jerusalem.

vss. 1-2—Babylon vs. Jerusalem: all of prophecy is about these two cities. Just as Judah, the people of typical Jerusalem, disobeyed God and for that were sent into captivity, into typical Babylon; so to, the church, the people of anti-typical Jerusalem, or the heavenly New Jerusalem, have disobeyed God, fallen, and for that, have been sent into captivity, into anti-typical Babylon. This is why both, the New Jerusalem and Babylon, appear so prominently in *the book of Revelation*. And just as typical Cyrus “destroyed” Babylon, ending Judah’s Babylonian captivity, and returning them back to Jerusalem, so to, very soon, our anti-typical Cyrus, Jesus Christ, will come to destroy anti-typical Babylon, ending the church’s Babylonian captivity, and “returning” us back to the New Jerusalem.

Revelation 16:12: And the sixth angel poured out his vial upon **the great river Euphrates** (the site of Babylon); and **the water thereof was dried up, that the way of the kings of the east** (the anti-typical Persian kings, one of which is anti-typical Cyrus, that is, Jesus Christ) **might be prepared**.

Don't believe that the church is in captivity? Read on then and study the prophecies of the Bible and the history of the church. You will be amazed at what has remained hidden in prophecy, *the books of Daniel and Revelation*, for 2,000 years.

vss. 6,7,11,18-19—“Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah”: *have you noticed they are listed in alphabetical order (according to the Hebrew alphabet)?* Interesting! So *why four?* Because four is a deeply symbolic number. It is the four camps of the camp of the wilderness wanderings of the children of Israel. (See *Numbers 2:1-31*) Because these four camps are towards the four directions, it is the four directions. Ultimately, the four of the four camps are the four standards of the camps, or more precisely, the four creatures on them: the lion, the man, the bull, and the eagle. The four are the four gospels: *Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John*. The four are the four cherubim surrounding God’s throne in heaven. (See *Revelation 4:6-7; Ezekiel 1:5-6, 10, 26; 10:1, 14-15, 20.*) The four are the four angels of *Revelation 14 and 18*. The four are even Noah and his three sons. (See *Genesis*) Ultimately, all these four represent Christ and his bride, the 144,000. Thus, the story of Daniel and his three friends are the story of God’s last great preaching and teaching movement, the 144,000. *Are they important to us?* Yes! At least, they should be!

The Four Camps of the Wilderness Wanderings of Israel*		
Camp	Direction	Standard
Judah	East	Lion
Ruben	South	Man
Ephraim	West	Bull
Dan	North	Eagle

*the ordering of the middle two are reversed with respect to the four living creatures of *Revelation 4*, the Gospels, etc.

God’s Four:

4 Living Creatures		4 Gospels		4 Sides of Christ	Daniel & His 3 Friends*
Earth	Lion	Synoptic Gospels	Matthew	King	Daniel
	Calf		Mark	Sacrifice/Servant	Hananiah
	Man		Luke	Man	Mishael
Heaven	Eagle	—	John	God	Azariah

*In *Daniel 1 & 2*, I am uncertain of the ordering of the four, of how they align with the four creatures.

His 3 Friends in the Furnace*		4 Angels’ Messages	
Man	Hananiah	3 Angels’ Messages (ch. 14)	1st Angel: Worship the Creator
	Mishael		2nd Angel: Babylon is Fallen
	Azariah		3rd Angel: Don’t Worship the Beast
God	Son of God	4th Angel’s Message (ch. 18)	4th Angel: Come out of Babylon

**In *Daniel 3*, I am uncertain of the ordering of the first three, of how they align with the first three creatures.

Noah and His Companions		
	Prior to the Flood*	In the Ark & During the Flood**
The 3	Methuselah	Shem
	Lamech	Ham
	Noah	Japheth
The 4th	—	Noah

*I am uncertain of the ordering of the first three, of how they align with the first three creatures.

**I am uncertain of the ordering of the four, of how they align with the four creatures. Is Noah the 4th???

The Anti-Four: (There is an anti-four!)

4 Metals (Dan. 2)*	4 Beasts (Dan. 7)*	4 Horns (Dan. 8)	4 Beasts (Rev. 13 & 17)	
Gold	Lion	east horn	ch. 13	Lion-Mouthed beast
Silver	Bear	pleasant land		Lamb-Like-Horned beast
Bronze	Leopard	south horn		Image Beast
Iron	4th Non-Descript Beast	little horn	ch. 17	Wilderness "Eagle" Beast

*I am uncertain of the ordering of the middle two. The Lion/Gold is the first. The Iron/fourth beast must be the last since this is the king of the north.

vss. 12,14-15,20—Prove/Test On the 10: symbolic of the most prominent 10 in the entire Bible, the most well known biblical 10 in the world... the 10 Commandments! *How do we know? Are there some hints?* Yes! Daniel's name occurs 10 times in this chapter. Go count them if you doubt me. *Why is that significant?* Because Daniel is a compound of dan, "judge", and "El", God, meaning "God is my judge". *How are we judged?* By God's law, the 10 commandments. Notice also that it literally says that Daniel and his friends were found to be "ten hands" by Nebuchadnezzar. "Ten hands"? Reminds me of *Revelation* (in light of *Deuteronomy*).

Revelation 13:16: And he causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads:

Deuteronomy 6:6-8: ⁶ And these words, which I command thee this day [the 10 Commandments of the previous chapter], shall be in thine heart: ⁷ And thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thine house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up. ⁸ And thou shalt bind them for a sign upon thine hand, and they shall be as frontlets between thine eyes.

"10 hands" a mark of God's 10 Commandments on our hands or our actions? I think so!

vss. 12,16—Vegetables: a plant based diet. As close to Eden's diet as is humanly possible at this time. While diet is not explicitly part of the 10 Commandments, it is implicitly. We are called to love God with all of our hearts and minds, a summary of the first four Commandments, and the sixth commandment commands us to not kill, including self-killing or suicide. To eat what knowingly is bad for us is to knowingly be committing a slow suicide. Not only this, but, if love for God demands of us our best, *how can we eat stuff that knowingly is harming our body and mind and then offer these damaged goods to God?* However, remember that we are stewards of the means God has granted to us. If you cannot afford to buy the best food because it will then make it impossible to carry out other works for God, please do what God has placed on your heart. Diet is important but it is most certainly not everything. God does not expect us to do the impossible. Though, God can do the impossible, so, pray!

ch. 1—The Story of the Structure: the world is in search of "wise men."

Daniel 12:3-4: ³ And they that be wise shall shine as the brightness of the firmament; and they that turn many to righteousness as the stars for ever and ever. ⁴ But thou, O Daniel, shut up the words, and seal the book, even to the time of the end: many shall run to and fro (back and forth over a scroll of the prophecies), and knowledge (of the prophecies) shall be increased.

These "wise men" will ultimately be found in God's church that has been taken into captivity into Babylon. God's people must be unwilling to be defiled with "the delicacies of the king (of Babylon) and the wine which he drank" (this king who is ultimately the devil), whether this be worldly diet, entertainment television and films, worldly music, sports, drugs, sex, pornography, etc.—anything that defiles, anything that turns our minds from Christ and interferes with our relationship with Him.

Revelation 17:2: With whom the kings of the earth have committed fornication, and the inhabitants of the earth have been made drunk with the wine of her fornication.

Revelation 18:3: For all nations have drunk of the wine of the wrath of her fornication, and the kings of the earth have committed fornication with her, and the merchants of the earth are waxed rich through the abundance of her delicacies.

God's people must be willing to be put to the test by God's 10 Commandments. Remember, man can not pass that test without God's strength. If we prove faithful, God will give us the wisdom needed to stand up for him in and to the world. Ultimately, it will be seen that we have been sealed by God's law. It will be visible in our hand, "ten hands" (vs. 20), that is, our actions, for our hearts and minds can not be read by our fellow men.